



Ant Atkinson entertains fans during a game at the Bradley Center in Milwaukee on Dec. 31, 2010.

WANT TO GO?

The Harlem Globetrotters will take on the Washington Generals at Goettge Memorial Field House aboard Camp Lejeune on March 23 at 7 p.m. Tickets, starting at \$17, are on sale at harlemglobetrotters.com, the Goettge Memorial Field House box office, or by phone at 866-468-3401. Information on obtaining group and scout tickets can also be found at the Globetrotters' website.

Harlem Globetrotters slated to visit Lejeune

By ANIESA HOLMES

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When the Harlem Globetrotters visit Camp Lejeune, they'll bring their world-famous trick skills to the court—and reveal a brand-new one.

The Globetrotters will bring, comedy, excitement and more as they face off against their most well-known and recognized opponents, The Washington Generals on March 23 at 7 p.m. at Goettge Memorial Fieldhouse aboard Camp Lejeune. For more than eight decades, the Harlem Globetrotters have been a prolific example of positive sportsmanship and quality entertainment for audiences around the world.

The team has given some of the nation's most talented athletes a chance to embrace, entertain and motivate people of all ages and cultural backgrounds through the sport.

The Harlem Globetrotters are traveling as a part of the 2011 "4 Times the Fun" North American tour across 220 cities in 46 U.S. and six Canadian provinces, which is the team's 85th season of touring. Hot Shot Branch, who is in his eighth season as a guard for the Globetrotters, said that the team plans to bring that same energy and fun to the area this month.

"We go out and do what the Globetrotters do, which is tour the world and share the game of basketball," Branch said. "We are ambassadors of goodwill and we bring different walks of life together and have a great time. It's a competitive game but at the same time we have fun."

Known for contributing more innovations to the game of basketball than any other team in history, Branch and his teammates have introduced the first-ever 4-point shot as part of all of its games this year. The feature includes designated 4-point shooting spots that will be placed on each side of midcourt, each located 35 feet from the basket and 12 feet beyond the NBA's official 3-point line.

"You're going to get the great Globetrotter tradition and that is a lot of laughter and entertainment and some amazing athletes that do some wonderful things with the basketball," Branch said. "Then you're going to see something that's never been done in history, which is the 4-point shot."

Branch also warned that audiences shouldn't be surprised if they are escorted out of their seats and onto the court to take pictures, receive autographs, shoot basketballs and give hi-fives with the players.

"We're going to pull people down out of their seats and get them to interact with us," Branch said. "We do the YMCA and the traditional Waterbucket, where we throw water and confetti and that's what everyone loves to see."

Branch also said that their goal is more than just winning a game; it's about giving fans the best experience of their lives. They also want to encourage young people who aspire to become athletes or any ambition to never stop trying.

"We tell them to dream your dream and never give up," Branch said. "With every success you're going to take some losses but that's not the end of the road, it's just part of your journey."

After many years, television and movie appearances, tours and more the Globetrotters are giving their best shot to make history and have a great time with their fans along the way.

"We started doing community work and going out and letting everyone know who we are and that it's more than just a game of basketball," Branch said. "We started a long time ago planting those seeds and now 85 years later we're still doing the same thing."

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